

**HR Policy****Defines the Policy and Procedure for Employees of Utthunga****Project Name**

HR Policy

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UT/QMS/SFP/RM

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ACRONYMS

PM	Project Manager
HR	Human Resource
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
CXO	Chief X Officer (generic term for job title where X represents the specific position)

REVISION HISTORY

SL. No.	Document Version No.	Change Description	Reason for change	Date Prepared By	Date Reviewed By	Date Approved By
1	1.0	Initial Draft	QSP Release 1.0	Rama G	Rama G	24 Jan, 2013 Krishnan KM

2	2.0	1.Added Purpose 2.Updated About the Company 3. Updated Mission and Vision 4.Restrictured Organization Structure 5.Restrictured Organization Chart 6.Updated Policy on Induction & Orientation 7.Updated Policy on Training & Probation Confirmation 8. Restructured Policy on Training & Development 9.Updated Performance Management 10. Updated Policy on Employee Transfers 11.Updated Policy on Employee Safety 12.Updated Exit Policy 13.Added Policy on Employee Termination 14.Updated Policy on Work Schedule	Revisit of policy	Amulya MS/Megha B	Amulya MS/Mohan S/Giridhar/Karthik B	27 Dec 2018 Krishnan KM
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		15. Restructured Policy on Leaves & excluded Compensatory off 16. Updated Policy on Holidays 17. Updated Policy on Salary Administration 18. Excluded Business Travel Policies 19. Updated Policy on Dress Code 20. Added Employee Engagement 21. Added Employee Benefits 22. Restructured Policy on Non-Disclosure & Confidentiality 23. Added Company Confidential Information 24. Updated Policy on Grievances 25. Updated Policy on Communication 26. Restructured Policy on Sexual Harassment 27. Added Whistleblower's Protection Policy 28. Added Disciplinary Action				
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3	2.1	1.Organization Structure 2.Organization Chart 3.Releiving formalities – Notice period	Revisit of policy	Amulya MS/Meg ha B	Amulya MS	23 April 2019 Abhijit MK
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7	2.5	6. Added Policy on Salary Advance 7. Added Policy on Employee Relocation 1. Updated Probation period	Revisit of policy	Rekha KK	Giridhar Karanth	22 nd Feb'22 Giridhar Karanth
8	2.6	12. Earned Leave Encashment	Update on EL	Ankita P	Rekha KK	13 th Jun'22 Rekha KK
9	2.7	14.2 Referral Bonus	Update on Referral Bonus	Ankita P	Rekha KK	22 nd Jul'22 Rekha KK
10	2.8	13.3 Annual Appraisal	Updated on Appraisal cycle	Ankita P	Rekha KK	23 rd Aug'22 Rekha KK
11	2.9	9.1.1 Flexi Hours	Updated on Working hours	Ankita P	Deepa C	1 st Feb'23 Amulya MS

1 Purpose

Welcome to Utthunga family. The purpose of this handbook is to provide the employees with an information resource for common questions and concerns along with procedures and consequences. The policies stated in this handbook are subject to change at any time at the sole discretion of the Company. From time to time, employees may receive updated information regarding any changes in policy. The contents of this handbook are not intended to create a contract or agreement between the Company and employees. There are specific procedures for many of the general policies stated in the handbook. Please direct any of your questions to the manager or to Human Resource (HR) Department. All activities carried out by employees under the supervision of Company management, at Company or at customer locations, are required to comply with the guidelines specified within this handbook. Any employee commits any breach or in violation of these policies is subject to disciplinary action including but not necessarily limited to, termination. In this handbook, the word “Company” is used as synonym for Utthunga Technologies Pvt Ltd. including its subsidiaries and affiliates.

2 About the Company

A product engineering and Industrial Solution company. We engineer industrial-grade digital products and solutions for industrial OEMs, Industries, ISVs, and Service Providers. We provide software development, firmware & hardware development, IIoT applications, IT-OT integration, field device integration, industrial communications, security engineering and testing services to global industrial OEMs and manufacturers. Besides these horizontal technology offerings, our domain-based vertical expertise in Process, Factory, Power, Building and Mobility domains enable us to function as a very dependent partner for our customers across the globe. Our strategic consulting and solutions help customers to transform their business with minimal risks.

3 Vision and Mission of the Company

3.1 Vision

- To be preferred and trusted technology partner -and solution partner.

3.2 Mission

- Deliver the best possible and reliable software solutions to help our clients improve efficiency and business profitability

- Commitment to meet customer satisfaction and establish mutually beneficial relationship with the customer by understanding the requirements, delivering services adhering to quality, effort, schedule, and cost as agreed upon
- To continually upgrade our processes and strive to become the successful business partner of our customer

4 Organization Structure

Organizational Structure			
Sl. No.	Designation	Functional Roles	Grade
1	CEO/ Co-founder & Director / Managing Director		Title holders
3	CXO / CTO / CFO		G10
3	Vice President	Automation Solutions/Engineering Solutions/Automotive Solutions/Embedded/Engineering/Technology/Practice/Delivery/ Industry Solution Support: HR/Account/Process Excellence/System Administrator/Sales/BD/Admin/Marketing/Digital Marketing/SEO	G9
4	Senior Director/ Associate Vice President / Head	Automation Solutions/Engineering Solutions/Automotive Solutions/Embedded/ Automation Testing/Engineering/Technology/Practice/Delivery/ Industry Solution/ Industrial Connectivity Solutions/Strategic accounts Support: HR/Account/Process Excellence/System Administrator/Sales/BD/Admin/Marketing/Digital Marketing/SEO	G8

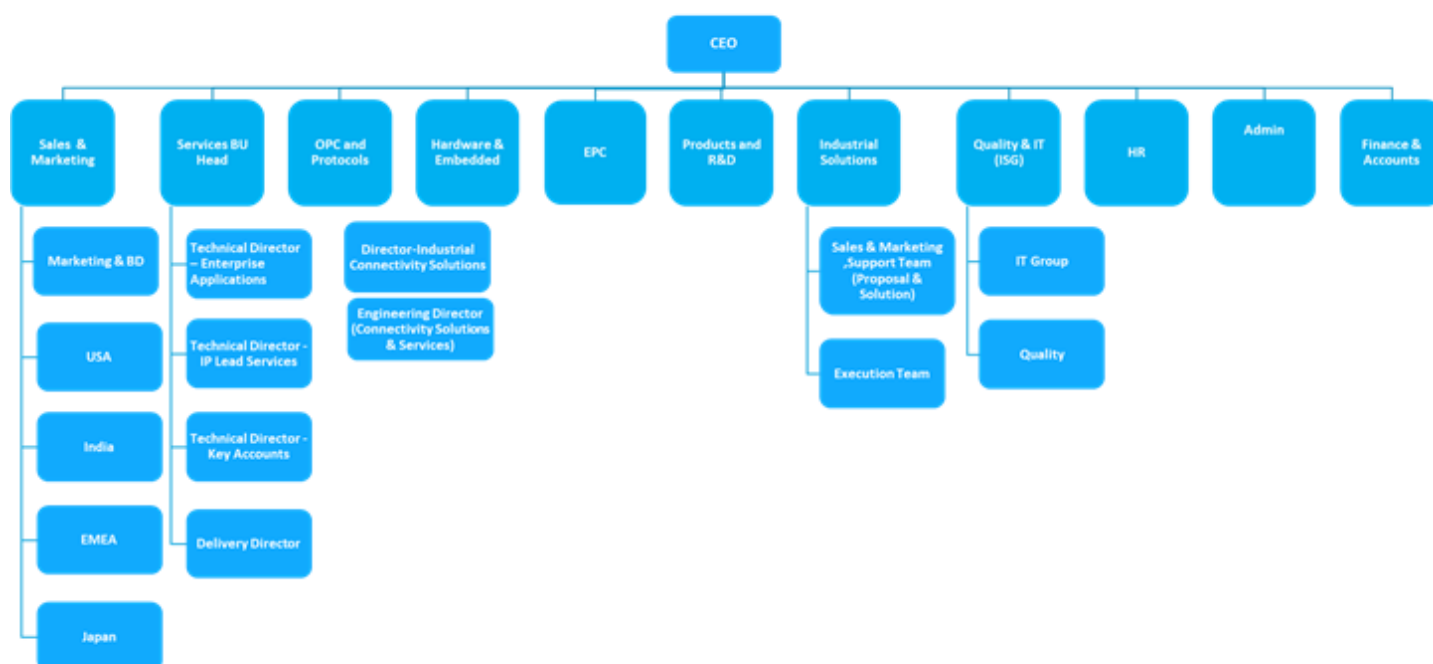
5	Director / Principal Architect	Automation Solutions/Engineering Solutions/ Engineering services /Automotive Solutions/Platform & Solutions/Industry solutions/Embedded/ Automation Testing/Engineering/Test engineering/Technology/Delivery/Account/ Products/Technical/ Solutions/ Industrial Connectivity Solutions/Strategic accounts Support: HR/HR Operation /Recruitment/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/Business Development (Key accounts)/Admin/Marketing/Digital Marketing/SEO/Marketing and BD	G7
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6	Assistant Director/Senior Manager/Senior Architect/Senior Designer	Projects/Delivery/ Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded/Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing /Embedded Testing/ Automation Testing/System/System Testing/Technical/ Solutions/ Industrial Connectivity Solutions/Strategic accounts/Key Accounts/Lab/PMO Support: HR Operation /Recruitment/Learning & Development/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/Solution Sales/Regional sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO	G6
7	Manager/Architect/Senior lead	Projects/Delivery/ Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded/Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing /Embedded Testing/ Automation Testing/System/System Testing/Technical/Security/Solutions/Strategic accounts/Key Accounts/Lab/PMO Support: HR Operation /Learning & Development /Recruitment/Finance & Accounts/Account/Process Excellence/ Quality/System Administrator/Sales/Solution Sales/Regional sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO/Content Writer	G5
8	Assistant Manager/ Lead	Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded/Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing /Embedded Testing/ Automation Testing/System/System Testing /Projects/Technical/Test/Technology/Designer/Security/ Strategic accounts/Key Accounts/Lab/PMO / System specialist Support: HR Operation /Learning & Development /Recruitment/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/Solution Sales/Regional sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO/Content Writer	G4

9	Senior Engineer/ Senior Executive / Senior Designer/Senior Analyst /Senior content Analyst	Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded/Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing/Learning and Development /Embedded Testing/ Automation Testing/Technical/Testing/System/System Testing/UI UX/ Software Automation/UX/Domain/Solutions/Hardware/GUI designer/Proposal/Graphic designer Support: HR Operation /Learning & Development /Recruitment/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO/ Technical content writer/Sales Coordinator/Content Writer / Business	G3
10	Engineer/ Executive / Designer/Business Partner	Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded/Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing /Embedded Testing/ Automation Testing/System/System Testing/UI UX/Field/Software Automation/UX/Domain/Solutions/Hardware/GUI designer/Proposal/Graphic designer Support: HR Operation / Learning & Development /Recruitment/HR/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO/Service technician/Sales Coordinator/Content Writer	G2
11	Associate Engineer/ Associate Executive	Software/Firmware/Hardware /Embedded /Software Testing /Firmware Testing/Hardware Testing /Embedded Testing/Automation Testing/System/System Testing/UI UX/Field/Software Automation/UX/Domain/Solutions/Hardware/GUI designer/Proposal/Graphic designer / Installation & Maintenance Technician Support: HR Operation / Learning & Development	G1

		/Recruitment/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/Sales Coordinator /Business Development/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO/Technical writer/Office Assistant/Content Writer /	
12	Trainee	Engineer/Engineer Testing Support: HR Operation /Recruitment/Account/Process Excellence/ System Administrator/Sales/BD/Admin/ Marketing /Digital Marketing/SEO	G0

5 Organization Chart



6 Policy on Induction and Orientation

6.1 Induction

Human Resource Department offers “New Employee Induction Program” to the new hires to acquaint with the following:

- Company’s Overview

- b) Organizational Structure
- c) Business Groups & Departments
- d) Utthunga values and principles
- e) Company's Policy, Procedures, Rules and Regulations
- f) Process Excellence Practices
- g) Workplace's Code of Conduct
 - Working Hours
 - Attendance, Leaves and Timesheet
 - Dress Code
 - Lunch and Break Schedules
 - Company Asset Handling

6.2 Orientation

The HR department and the reporting manager has the responsibility to orientate the new hire with the following:

- a) Objective, Structure and Purpose of the Department
- b) Assigning a Buddy
- c) Departmental Policies and Procedures including:
 - Timesheet Authorization Procedures
 - Importance of Regular Attendance and Punctuality
 - Policy for reporting Absences and Tardiness
 - Job Description
 - Performance Standards/Expectations for Performance Appraisal
 - Problem-solving Mechanisms within the Department
 - Introduction to the Team
 - Policy on Probation & Confirmation

7 Policy on Training and Probation Confirmation

7.1 Training Period (Applicable for Beginners/Fresher's only)

Training period refers to the period in which the employees are provided with important information, set of new skills or with opportunities to professionally develop and grow.

A beginner/fresher will undergo training for minimum of 02 months. The training period is assumed to be extended until the employee has not received his/her Training Period Completion Letter through HRMS portal. While the resource is under training program, he/she will have to sign a Service Agreement for 2 years. These details will be mentioned in the offer letter.

By conducting relevant assessments/tests, the manager shall review the performance of the project trainee at the end of training period and shall recommend the HR department on successful completion of the

training program. The HR department shall generate a "Training Period Completion Letter " to the employee on successful completion of the training in HRMS portal.

During the training period, Company reserves the right to terminate the services without giving any notice and is not bound to give any reason thereof. Employees are not eligible for any type of leave during the training period.

7.2 Probation Period

Probation Period refers to assessment period of closely evaluating the work of new employee in the Company or business.

Initially, employees shall be kept under probationary period minimum of 6 months (in case of beginners/fresher's, this period will commence on successful completion of training period). These details will be mentioned in the offer letter. The probationary period is assumed to be extended for minimum 1 month and maximum 2 months within which if the employee has not received his/her letter of confirmation -through HRMS portal, employment will be deemed as terminated.

The Company will closely monitor the performance during this period. By conducting relevant assessments, the manager shall review the performance at the end of probation period and recommend the HR Department for confirmation of services. In case of any delays by the manager, HR shall send three reminders for the assessment. In spite of reminders if the manager fails to take any action, by considering the morale of the employee as priority his/her probation status will be auto approved. Respective managers will be held responsible for this process incase if the assessments would be resulting in employment discharge. The HR department shall generate a "Letter of Confirmation" to the employee on successful completion of the probation period in HRMS portal.

At any time, employee may terminate employment contract by issuing three (3) month's prior notice in writing and the Company reserves the right to terminate employment contract by issuing one(1) month's prior notice to employee without assigning any reason thereof. The Company reserves the right to pay or recover salary in lieu of notice period, relieve employee before the expiry of the notice period and employee shall not be entitled to avail and set off leaves against the notice period.

7.3 Internship procedure

An internship is an opportunity employer's offer to students interested in gaining work experience in specific industries, and an important step to building a solid career.

Company's internship program is based on the college requirement an intern works for a fixed period, usually two months which also count towards course credit in his/her college.

An offer letter will be issued on the joining day and will be allocated to respective manager. By conducting relevant assessments/tests, the manager shall review the performance of the intern at the end of internship period and shall recommend the HR department on successful completion of the internship program.

The HR department shall issue "Internship Completion Letter "to the intern on successful completion of the internship and a copy of related documents shall be maintained by HR department. This is an unpaid internship program.

8 Policy on Learning and Development

Learning and development is one of the key HR functions. It ensures that Company allocates the right people with the right skills to do the right jobs. Company attributes importance to continuing education and human resource development.

Learning and development is intended to equip employees with the necessary skills, knowledge and understanding to enable them to function in the working environment with competence and confidence.

8.1 Governing Rules for Learning and Development

8.1.1 Mandatory Training Days

Employees must mandatorily undergo min 10 days of training per financial year (Jan to Dec) at the Company.

- Mandatory, Project need based, Domain and Soft Skills training

8.1.2 Trainings for Career Development

- It is the responsibility of every employee in consensus with their manager to complete all mandatory and soft skill trainings matching their career band (which is presented in the career development framework)
 - The career development framework is the progression ladder which is designed and developed for an employee to move from one career band to another.
 - This framework develops skills that are necessary for an individual to possess to perform that role
 - There are 3 dimensions of development Mandatory, Behavioral and Technical
 - Each dimension has trainings mapped which is mandatory for an individual to attend and complete
 - Apart from attending trainings they have to also complete assessments and certain other parameters for progression.
 - The complete detail of the framework and the programs is available in the QMS document

The detailed information about Career development framework is uploaded in QMS. For further reference w.r.t Career development visit the below link:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/CareerDevelopmentFramework_TechnicalWorkforce.pdf

Training Request and Nomination

- A manager can request for a training if need be, for his/her project by filling the Training Request Form (TRF) and this shall be conducted as a class room training / online training based on the training requested.
- An employee nominated for the program by self / manager gets a meeting invite about the details of the program which the individual must respond with acceptance/ decline.

- Nominated employee accepts the learning invite sent will have to attend the program and if they must opt out of the program, they can do so two days prior to the program.
- In case they accept and do not turn up for the session they would be marked as defaulter resulting in not being eligible to attend any further programs for the year.
- Employees do have an opportunity to express their feedbacks post the learning session through a feedback form.
- Some of the trainings might also be linked with an assessment which is mandatory for the participant to complete.
- The effectiveness of the training is measured by the business benefit form. The reporting managers administer this after 15 days of completion of the training. The form is available in QMS.

The detailed information about Learning and Development is uploaded in QMS. For further reference w.r.t Learning and Development visit the below link:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/ProcessDocuments/Training.pdf

9 Policy on Work Schedule

9.1 Policy on Work Timings

The regular working hours at the Company is between 9:00AM till 6:30PM from Monday till Friday that includes 60 minutes of break time. Minimum 5 hours of working will be considered as half day. However, depending upon necessity, workload and requirement, there could be a variation for an employee in his/her time schedule to complete the assigned task. If required, the employees are expected and imperative to work on Saturdays and extra hours as a part of normal work schedule. If an employee is outside of the office for non-business related reasons during their normal work schedule, they should notify their manager.

9.1.1 Flexi Hours

Different start and end times for your workday than the standard 9 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. Essentially, having flexible work hours means employees can begin their work earlier in the day or later than the originally set time.

Employees who log in little late and work till late night as per the projects or work flow, for example if a employee log in after 11 and works even till late night it is considered as half day because as per the policy the log in time is 9.00am till 6.30, later again employee have to raise Correction request to convert as present, so this flexi hours has been initiated to eradicate the constraints and adopt the normal working.

Its mandatory that employee must complete 9.5 hours of working every day and should plan their work schedules, meetings, projects accordingly and take approval from reporting manager if the time deviation is more (for example: Early leave, late login, any emergency in between etc.) they must complete the 9.5 hours or raise the Attendance Regulation or On Duty request accordingly.

9.2 Policy on Attendance

Regular attendance is essential to the Company's efficient operation and is a necessary condition of employment. Employees are expected to report to work at 9.00AM on each scheduled work day. Due to absenteeism, schedules and customer commitments fall behind, therefore, other employees have to assume added workloads. Excessive absenteeism (unauthorized more than 5 days) shall result in disciplinary actions which can include termination of the employment. Employees are requested to swipe in to the biometric access machine during entry into and exit from the office. Our employees are expected to maintain their daily Timesheet failing which it will be considered as absenteeism, and it impacts their payroll.

9.3 Policy on late coming and Absence

Reporting for work regularly and on time is essential, as tardiness or absence interferes with the daily running of the Company in terms of delivery schedule slippage, loss of productivity, customer dissatisfaction and also may lead to an extra workload on fellow team members. Failure to report to work regularly on time is cause for disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. Employees are expected to be at their workstations on time.

9.3.1 Late Coming

We expect employees to strive to maintain the discipline and to arrive for work on time. We recognize that on certain occasions, the employee may not be able to come to work in time or need additional time before they arrive. In those circumstances, the employee must give early notice to the manager and HR through call/email. Notification to a fellow employee shall not be considered as a proper notice. Regular excessive tardiness may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. The manager has the responsibility to notify the HR department about excessive tardiness of their subordinates, if any.

9.3.2 Absence

There are occasions when employees cannot report to work. Sickness and other emergencies cannot always be anticipated and may require you to miss all or part of your work day. In the event that employees are unable to report to work as scheduled, he/she should call/email and let the manager know within 24 hours, in advance when possible, so that arrangements for other help can be made. If the need for time off is predictable, the employee must inform well in advance as possible. Employees must give the reason for the anticipated absence, when they can be reached, and their anticipated absence from work. Employees must either call/email the manager on each consecutive day of absence or give an anticipated return date based on medical advice. Notification to a fellow employee shall not be considered as a proper notice. Employees may be granted excused absences for sickness/illness when the appropriate person is notified prior to the start of work. In such times, it shall be taken as paid leave, assuming the employee has such leave available; otherwise, it shall be considered as unpaid leave.

If an employee absents himself without any prior notification/information, it is the responsibility of the manager to inform the HR through email, who will send a letter/email of absenteeism to the employee. If no information is received within 5 days of dispatch of the letter/email, the absence will be treated as abandonment of services and the legal procedures to be initiated from the HR and it will also lead to legal actions and/or immediate termination.

10 Policy on Dress Code

As an employee of the Company, we expect you to present a clean and professional appearance when you represent us, whether that is in, or outside of the office. Management, sales personnel and those employees who come in contact with our client, are expected to dress in accepted corporate tradition. It is just as essential that you act in a professional manner and extend the highest courtesy to co-workers, visitors, customers, vendors and clients. A cheerful and positive attitude is essential to our commitment to extraordinary customer service and impeccable quality. The Company maintains a business working environment. All employees should be cautious in wearing attire that is appropriate for the office and customer interaction. All employees are instructed to have business casual from Monday to Thursday and casuals on Friday.

11 Policy on Leaves

11.1 Leave Policy

The Company has a leave policy that is tailored to its need and culture. There are also statutory rules from the government that need to be taken into consideration. A good leave policy is simple, easy to administer, fair to all parties and compliant with the statutory requirements. Employees need to be made aware of the Leave Policy. Leave policy will be followed as the calendar year i.e., 1st January to 31st December

Leave Types

The Company offers the following leaves apart from general holidays:

- Casual leave
- Sick Leave
- Earned leave
- Maternity leave
- Paternity leave
- Bereavement leave

SI No	Type of Employment	Period of Employment	CL	SL	EL	
			Jan - Dec	Jan - Dec	Jan - Dec	Carry forward to next year
1	Regular	Permanent	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
2	New Employee	Probation	NA	NA	Yes	Yes
3	New Employee	Employment confirmation	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
4	New Employee	Training	NA	NA	NA	NA

As per the Karnataka statutory board, the total leaves to be considered in the organization are as below:

- 6 Casual leaves to be considered for a calendar year
- 6 Sick leaves to be considered for a calendar year

11.1.1 Casual Leaves

Every employee is entitled to leave with wages on any reasonable ground. In case of Casual leaves, approval is required either before the leave has been availed. Leaves are considered only for the working days.

11.1.1.1 Casual Leaves Credit Process

- 6 casual leaves for the calendar year shall be entitled for regular employees
- The personnel whose employment status is trainee or probation is not eligible for casual leaves
The number of casual leaves for the calendar year shall be entitled based on the employment confirmation which will be pro-rated from the employment confirmation date till December 31 of that calendar year. For instance, if the probation period of an employee who has joined on 1st of January, completes by 30th June (06 months), he/she will be entitled for - 3 days of casual and sick leave for that calendar

Pro-rate basis calculation:

Pro-rate formula: $((\text{Total months in a year} - \text{probation served months in a calendar year}) * \text{casual/sick leave}) / \text{Total months in a year}$

From the above instance $((12-6)*6)/12 = 3$ days

- If he/she joins between 1st to 15th of that month, that month will not be considered for the calculation i.e., 13th March joined will be $(12 - 2)$
- If he/she joins between 16th to 30th of that particular month, that month will be considered for the calculation i.e., 16th March joined will be $(12 - 3)$

11.1.1.2 Casual Leave credit structure

Sl No	Type of Employment	Period of Employment	CL	
			Jan - Dec	Carry Forward to next year
1	Regular	Permanent	6	NA
2	New Employee	Probation	0	NA
3	New Employee	Employment confirmation	Pro rata-based calculation on 06 CL	NA
4	New Employee	Training	0	NA

11.1.1.3 Availing Clause on Casual Leave

- This leave shall not be clubbed/combined with any of the holidays/sick leaves/earned leaves
- Maximum 02 leaves at a time can be availed i.e., 02 continuous working days

11.1.1.4 Casual Leave Approval Procedure

Casual leave should be applied in HRMS tool and approved from the respective Manager before the leave has been availed. If the HRMS tool is not accessible for any employee, he/she has to get back to the HR or shall apply through email and get it approved from the respective Manager.

11.1.2 Sick Leaves

Every employee shall be entitled for “leave with wages”, during the twelve months of continuous service, for a period not exceeding six (06) days, on the ground of any sickness incurred or accident sustained by him/her or for any other reasonable cause.

11.1.2.1 Sick Leave Credit Process

- 6 sick leaves for the calendar year shall be entitled for regular employees
- The personnel whose employment status is trainee or probation are not eligible for sick leave
- The number of sick leaves for the calendar year shall be entitled based on the employment confirmation which will be pro-rated from the employment start date through December 31 of that calendar year. For the employees who will be in the probation period e.g., If the probation period of an employee who has joined on 1st of January, completes by June end (06 months), he/she will be entitled for $6/12 \times 6 = 3$ days of leave for that calendar year

* Sick leave shall lapse at the end of the calendar year

11.1.2.2 Sick Leaves credit structure

SI No	Type of Employment	Period of Employment	SL	
			Jan - Dec	Carry Forward to next year
1	Regular	Permanent	6	NA
2	New Employee	Probation	0	NA
3	New Employee	Employment confirmation	Prorata based calculation on 06 SL	NA
4	New Employee	Training	0	NA

11.1.2.3 Availing Clause on Sick Leave

- Availing sick leave exceeding 2 working days needs to be supported with doctor's certificate
- This leave shall be clubbed/combined with any of the casual leaves/earned leaves if available, in certain circumstances i.e. in the event of prolonging illness, the doctor's certificate must be given or else it will be considered as loss of pay.

11.1.2.4 Sick Leave Approval Procedure

Sick leave should be applied in HRMS tool and must be approved from the respective Manager before the leave has been availed. If the HRMS tool is not accessible for any employee, he/she has to get back to the HR or shall apply through email and get it approved from the respective Manager.

Eligibility criteria casual/sick leaves w.r.t pro rate basis

The number of leaves will be considered based on the probation completion date of an employee and same shall be credited. We can make this for all type of leave credits based on DOJ for example:

- If the probation completion date of an employee is less than or equal to 15 days in a month then the number of casual/sick leave for the working days of that particular month will be considered
- If the probation completion date of an employee is greater than 15 days in a month then the number of casual/sick leave for the working days of that particular month will not be considered
- If an employee is serving the probation/notice period, he/she will not be eligible for casual/sick leaves

11.1.3 Earned Leaves

These are the leaves which the employee earns as they work for an organization for a specific number of days. These are also known as privilege leaves and can be carry forwarded. Marriage leaves should be availed from Earned leaves

11.1.3.1 Earned Leave Credit Process

- Earned leaves to be considered for a year is based on number of working days of the year e.g. if an employee worked for full complete working calendar year (12 months) then he/she is eligible for 12 days
- Earned Leaves are credited monthly once in a calendar year to every employee's account i.e. on completion of every month one leave will be credited. Leave credit shall be considered as per the Leave credit structure table
- The number of earned leaves will be considered based on the DOJ of an employee and same shall be credited. For example:
 - If the DOJ of an employee is less than or equal to 10th day of the month then the number of earned leave for the working days of that particular month will be considered as 01 day
 - If the DOJ of an employee is greater than 10th day of the month then the number of earned leave for the working days of that particular month will be considered as 0.5 day
 - If the DOJ of an employee is greater than or equal to 25th day of the month then he/she shall not be eligible for the earned leave of that particular month

- If an employee is serving the notice period, he/she shall not be eligible for earned leave during the notice period and shall not be credited
- Employee's un-availed earned leaves will be carry forward to the next calendar year is limited to less than or equal to 06 days
- During the notice period, employee's un-availed earned leaves will be carry forward to the next calendar year is not limited to less than or equal to 06 days and any of the EL clause is not applicable for the resigned employees

11.1.3.2 Earned/Privilege Leave Credit and Carry forward structure

Sl. No.	Type of Employment	Period of Employment	EL	
			Jan – Dec	Carry Forward to next year
1	Regular	Permanent	12 (monthly 1EL will be credited for the previous month work)	6
2	New Employee	Probation	12 (monthly 1EL will be credited for the previous month work)	6
3	New Employee	Employment confirmation	12 (monthly 1EL will be credited for the previous month work)	6
4	New Employee	Training	NA	NA

11.1.3.3 Availing Clause on Earned Leave

- If the maximum number of availing of this leave is more than 2 days, the same has to be planned a month earlier and shall be approved by the respective Manager
- This leave shall not be clubbed/combined with any of the sick leaves/casual leaves
- Maximum 6 earned leaves shall be availed at a time in a calendar year with manager approval ○ To avail advanced earned leaves, employees should have at least one earned leave in the bucket. So, including the earned leaves in the bucket, total advance leaves that can be allotted is 6 days i.e., in total 6 days can be availed at once. For e.g.,
 - If an employee has 1 earned leave in the bucket, then he/she will get 5 advance earned leaves
 - If an employee has 2 earned leave in the bucket, then he/she will get 4 advance earned leaves

- Advance earned leave shall be opted only once in a calendar year
- Only Earned leave shall be availed for marriage leaves. The same has to be planned a month earlier and shall be approved by the respective manager 15days in advance.

11.1.3.4 Earned Leave Approval Procedure

Earned leave should be applied in HRMS tool and approved from the respective Manager before the leave has been availed. If the HRMS tool cannot be accessed by an employee, he/she has to get back to HR or shall apply through email and get it approved from the respective Manager.

11.1.3.5 Earned Leave Encashment

An employee can take leave encashment only while relieving from services, superannuation, discharge/termination, dismissal or death. The encashment amount will be paid to the employee at the time of full and final settlement.

Leave encashment is calculated on the basic salary of employee. If an employee has availed more than entitled leaves the same will be deducted at the time of full and final settlement.

The calculation for the encashment is $(\text{Basic} * \text{Number of leaves available}) / 30 \text{ days}$.

The earned leave encashment is considered based on the circumstances as given below:

During the notice period, unavailed earned leaves carry forward to the next calendar year are not limited to less than or equal to 06 days and any of the EL clause is not applicable for the resigned employee

- If an employee gets on boarded and resigned in same year (e.g., in the month of October), the unavailed earned leave will be considered till September
- If an employee gets on boarded in the year of 2017 and resigned in the year 2018 (e.g., in the month of March'18), the unavailed earned leave will be considered till the month February'18 (i.e., maximum 06 carry forwarded earned leave + unavailed earned leave of January'18 and February'18)
- If an employee is serving his notice period or relieved which falls between the leave lapsing period, the lapsed leaves will not be considered for encashment.
- If an employee resigned in the year of 2017 and relieved in the year 2018 (e.g., relived in the month of March'18), the unavailed earned leave will be considered for encashment after carry forward. (i.e., maximum 06 carry forwarded earned leave)

11.1.4 Maternity leave

Under section 9 of the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 deals with maternity leaves.

Female employees will be entitled to maternity leave up to a maximum of 6 months, provided the employee has been with the Company for at least 80 days.

Maternity leave with salary is applicable only for 1st and 2nd maternity. Employees are requested to apply for maternity leave well in advance to the HR department so that the necessary arrangements shall be made to take care of assigned tasks. Under the Maternity Benefit Amendment Act, this benefit could be

availed by women for a period extending up to a maximum of 8 weeks before the expected delivery date and the remaining time can be availed post childbirth. In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, a woman shall, on production of such proof as may be prescribed, be entitled to leave with wages at the rate of maternity benefit, for a period of six weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage or, as the case may be, her medical termination of pregnancy.

11.1.5 Paternity Leave

Male employees will be entitled to paternity leave up to a maximum of 05 days, provided the employee has been with the Company for at least 15 days. Paternity leave with salary is applicable only for 1st and 2nd paternity.

11.1.6 Bereavement Leave

In the event of death of immediate family member(s) (parents, spouse and children) of a regular employee, he/she normally be allowed up to 5 consecutive scheduled working days off immediately.

11.2 Leave without pay

Leave without pay (LOP) is a temporary non paid status and absence from duty that, in most cases, is granted at the employee's request. An employee who has an unauthorized absence immediately preceding or following a holiday is also not eligible for that holiday pay.

As an employee will be paid for full 30 or 31 days in a month, similarly when an employee will be on an unapproved/unauthorized leave which consists of Saturday and Sunday's, these days also been considered as LOP.

- For e.g., If an employee is on LOP for Friday and next Monday then he/she is also not eligible for the payment for Saturday and Sunday which will fall between those 2 days of LOP.

11.3 Policy on Holidays

The Company will observe and allow time-off with pay for 10 number of holidays per year including 5 national holidays. The detailed list of holidays will be intimated by the HR department every year at the end of the preceding year. At times, business needs may require employees to work on a holiday.

Onsite Employees:

- Leaves are applicable as per the Company Policy & Holidays are applicable as per Client's Policy till you are deputed at client place

Offshore Employees:

- Leaves & Holidays are applicable as per the Company Policy

12 Performance Management

Performance management is a process that provides feedback, accountability, and documentation for performance outcomes. It helps employees to channel their talents toward organizational goals.

12.1 S.M.A.R.T GOALS

S.M.A.R.T is an acronym, giving criteria to guide in the setting of objectives, for example in project management, employee-performance management, and personal development.

GOAL is an idea of the future or desired result that a person or a group of people envisions, plans and commits to achieve. People endeavor to reach goals within a finite time by setting deadline.

An S.M.A.R.T GOAL gives direction to what you want to achieve. In this way it will give a sense of direction to everyone who wants to achieve the goal and it is very likely that it can be really completed successfully. A well-formulated goal is easy to understand for everyone.

The acronym S.M.A.R.T stands for:

S – Specific

When setting a goal, be specific about what you want to accomplish by explaining parameters and think about this as the mission statement for your goal. This is not a detailed list of how you are going to meet a goal, but it should include an answer to the popular 'w' questions (like Who, What, When, Where, Which, Why).

M – Measurable

What metrics are you going to use to determine if you meet the goal? This makes a goal more tangible because it provides a way to measure progress. If it is a project that is going to take a few months to complete, then set some milestones by considering specific tasks to accomplish and levels of Performance Standards i.e. by adding specific weightage to the parameters and KRA defined.

There shall be five (5) levels to measure overall performance:

- a) **Exceptional:** Consistently performs all duties in an exceptional manner. Exceeds expectations and goes regularly beyond what is required of the job. Work is of the highest quality and quantity, highly responsive, requires little to no supervision. Rating shall be 5.
- b) **Above Expectations:** Works in a manner considerably above the normal expectations for the position - unusually high quality and quantity of work, frequently exceeds what is expected of the position, very responsive, requires minimum supervision. Rating shall be 4.
- c) **Meets Expectations:** Performs all duties in a competent manner and consistently meets all expectations for the position. This has a normal response time for work and requires normal time and attention from the manager. Rating shall be 3.
- d) **Below Expectations:** Meets some expectations for the job but requires improvement in quality and/or quantity of work, requires extra attention from the manager. Rating shall be 2.
- e) **Unsatisfactory:** Performance is not acceptable. Separation may be indicated or reassignment under appropriate circumstances. Excessive attention is required by the manager. Rating shall be 1.

A – Achievable

This focuses on how important a goal is to you and what you can do to make it attainable and may require developing new skills and changing attitudes. The goal is meant to motivate, not discourage. Think about how to accomplish the goal if you have the tools/skills needed. If you do not currently possess those tools/skills, consider what it would take to attain them.

R – Relevant

Relevance refers focusing on something that makes sense with the broader business goals. For example, if the goal is to launch a new product, it should be something that is in alignment with the overall business objectives. Your team may be able to launch a new consumer product, but if your Company is a B2B that is not expanding into the consumer market, then the goal would not be relevant.

T – Time-Bound

Anyone can set goals, but if it lacks realistic timing, chances are you are not going to succeed. Providing a target date for deliverables is imperative. Ask specific questions about the goal deadline and what can be accomplished within that time period. If the goal will take three months to complete, it is useful to define what should be achieved half-way through the process. Providing time constraints also creates a sense of urgency.

12.2 Quarterly Review

Company performs quarterly review process. The review period will be applicable from January to December of every financial year. Beginning of the quarter, All the Leads and Managers to upload the goals (**S.M.A.R.T GOALS**) to all the employees reporting to them, post this the employees to fill in their respective self and manager's inputs with a time bound. After the self-input, the manager fills the feedback for the employee. While filling, he/she will involve the HR in communicating the performance feedback to the employee. This is done every quarter and accumulated. For the Annual Appraisal review, all four quarters review ratings will be considered. As a growing Company, we shall be expecting a lot of project opportunities with our Clients. Those opportunities will be fulfilled by mapping with the active skill sets of the employees in the Organization. So, Company would expect employees compulsorily to update their respective profiles in the Company's profile template once they complete their projects.

12.3 Annual Appraisal

Company shall review performance during the month of December and / or June and appraisal during the month of January and / or July of every year as applicable to the employee. An employee who has joined the Company must complete minimum twelve months to be eligible for the appraisal cycle. The individual would be accessed and appraised during the nearest appraisal cycle and going forward he/she will be eligible for appraisal once in a year based on the performance feedback/rating. The previous 4 quarters and annual performance review ratings are mandatory and to be submitted on or before 31st December and / or 30th June every year for January and / or July cycle respectively. Below is the example to understand in detail:

DOJ	Review period	Revision period
January 2021	December 2021	January 2022
February 2021	December 2021	January 2022
March 2021	December 2021	January 2022
April 2021	December 2021	January 2022
May 2021	December 2021	January 2022
June 2021	December 2021	January 2022
July 2021	June 2022	July 2022

August 2021	June 2022	July 2022
September 2021	June 2022	July 2022
October 2021	June 2022	July 2022
November 2021	June 2022	July 2022
December 2021	June 2022	July 2022

Salary revisions and promotions based on Performance Appraisal will effect from 1st January and / or 1st July of every year. The policy on conducting annual appraisal and further action towards salary revisions are subject to change any time at the sole discretion of the Company.

12.4 PIP (Performance Improvement Program)

Performance Improvement Program is a process that focusses on performance improvement of an employee where the performance improvement is objectively assessed and based on the result of assessment the decision will be taken.

Performance Improvement Program process is as follows:

- If any employee's rating is 1 or 2 (bottom rating) in the Quarterly Review/Annual Appraisal and/or if any team lead/manager has concerns about team member's performance and conduct, then he/she will be subjected to PIP. However, there should be at least two verbal feedback followed by one e-mail where feedback is provided to the employee copying HR of his/her nonperformance and he/she is subjected to PIP. Duration of PIP will be minimum of 4 weeks and can extend till 6 weeks. Performance review will be continued during this period. In PIP form, the actual data (assignment) is captured by the lead on a week-on-week basis for the entire PIP duration.
- The manager discusses with the team member in HR's presence to share the current feedback, assignments and expected outcomes during the PIP period. Discussion shall be recorded.
- The assignments must have specific measurable results. The metrics to be used are effort variance, schedule variance and defect leakage. The goal during this period is up to the discretion of the manager.
- HR conveys to the employee that he/she shall be terminated even if one of the expected outcomes are not met. The employee shall continue to be on the job if the expectations are met and shall be under observation for the next 3 months. One employee can be subjected to only 2 PIP's per role/grade and in case the same employee is subjected to another PIP, which will result in immediate termination of such employee without any further notice period as specified in appointment letter
- After the meeting, the team member and the manager sign the PIP form to kick-off the program.
- Every week, the Manager updates the form and sends it to the HR and the employee. If there are any disagreements, it is resolved by the manager in HR's presence.
- Based on the result of the PIP program, the employee either continue with the Company or may get terminated/relieved from the Company
- The outcome is also recorded in soft copy/hard copy with signatures from the HR, Project Manager as well as the employee.

Exclusion: Trainee Engineers will not come under PIP

Note: If an employee has been under PIP in the last 6 months, then he/she is not eligible for upcoming appraisal, compensation, and benefits.

12.5 Performance culture

A high-performance culture involves the most beneficial behaviors and expectations that lead to superior results for an organization. Essentially, a performance culture drives high-achievement and positive results. It also involves setting specific business plans and expecting high-achieving employees to meet those goals. Variable pay is also known as performance pay, based upon the performance of both, Company and individual, it is used to recognize and reward employee contribution for the growth of the Company, above and beyond their normal job requirements, towards Company's productivity, profitability, and quality.

The variable pay is that it provides an incentive for employees (depends on their variable slab mentioned in their respective employment contract) to feel a sense of ownership and take responsibility for their jobs and relate to the overall performance of the Company. By introducing variable pay, the management would ensure that employees are motivated to contribute individually as a unit, division and finally as part of the whole Company.

According to the respective job grades in the Company the variable pay-outs across different levels has been divided. The variable pay-outs are based on the variable slabs as per their respective employment contract.

Currently Variable payouts is based on two main factors:

- Company's performance
- Individual performance

Both the types of variable payouts will be paid annually based on the achievement w.r.t company's performance and their individual performance (i.e., on the defined KRA's) respectively.

- **Below is the eligible criteria w.r.t Company's performance:**
 - An employee will be eligible for variable upon completion of the financial year which consists of four quarters i.e., 1st April to 31st March.
 - If an employee resigns / gets relieved before completion of the financial year which consists of four quarters i.e., 1st April to 31st March will not be eligible for the variable pay.
 - In case the employee is found guilty or charged with misconduct or has been issued notice for any violations of the terms of the appointment letter during the financial year, in such case an employee will forfeit the variable pay for that financial year.

- **Below is the eligible criteria w.r.t Individual performance:**

The individual performance shall be done on the respective KRA's. According to variable component slabs mentioned in variable payouts, excluding company's performance the remaining variable percentage will be paid on their individual performance annually based on the achievement w.r.t their defined KRA's.

- An employee will be eligible for the variable pay based on the defined KRA's and on completion of the financial year which consists of four quarters i.e., 1st April to 31st March
- To be entitled to receive variable pay an employee should have to complete at least one quarter. If an employee gets resigns/ relieved before completing any particular quarter, he/she will be eligible for the variable pay of the previous quarters and shall forfeit the eligibility during the quarter resigned/ relieved / terminated.
- In case the employee is found guilty or charged with misconduct or has been issued notice for any violations of the terms of the appointment letter during the financial year, in such case an employee will forfeit the variable pay for that financial year.

13 Policy on Salary Administrations and payments

Employees are paid for salary at the first working day of the next month. The salary will be credited to the employee's bank account. Salary Pay slips will be available in HRMS and can be downloaded through their respective login credentials.

13.1 Stipend payment procedure:

The payment process of stipend to trainees are done once in a month as per the Stipend payment HR Procedures Document. Below is the QMS link for reference:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Procedure%20document%20-%20Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf

13.2 Referral Bonus:

Employee referral program is designed keeping in mind equal opportunity for all employees to refer their candidate. Employee referral is qualitatively best source of hiring as employee making a referral is well known with the organizational culture, they refer someone who can make the best fit in the organization professionally as well as culturally.

The policy is effective 1st Jul 2022 and applicable basis the date of joining from this date.

1. The employee after noticing the requirement looks into their network and refers to a candidate if it is found suitable.
2. Referrer will upload CV in RMS portal mentioned in the advertisement.
3. Recruiters review the resume of the candidate and match the skill and qualities with the job description, If found suitable under the employee referral programs recruiter forward the CV to the hiring manager
4. The Candidate goes through the interview process and if shortlisted and selected informed by the recruiter and HR, After the final selection, the employee who has referred the candidate is informed about the selection of the candidate

5. The payment of referral bonus to referring employees is done once in a month i.e., on or before 10th working day subsequent month once referred employee completes 6 months from DOJ and probation completed as confirmed employee in Utthunga. The amount will be credited to the referring employee's bank account.

6.1 Referral Bonus payout details for technical team

Technical	
Experience in years	Referral Award
0-1	INR 1000
1.1-3	INR 10000
3.1-5	INR 25000
5.1-8	INR 30000
8 – 10	INR 40000
10+	INR 50000

6.2 Referral Bonus payout details for Support team

Support	
Experience in years	Referral Award
0-1	INR 1000
1.1-3	INR 3000
3.1-5	INR 5000
5.1-8	INR 10000
8 – 10	INR 12000
10+	INR 15000

Note: Support includes departments such as HR, IT, Quality, Sales, Accounts, Admin.

The payment process of referral bonus to referred Employees are done once in a month as per the referral bonus HR Procedures Document. Below is the QMS link for reference:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Procedure%20document%20-%20Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf

14.3 Income Tax

Tax deduction (for the applicable employees) will be made based on the computation as per the Income Tax Act, 1961 based on the salary and investment declaration submitted by the respective employee. Form 16 for the tax payable employee will be prepared by Payroll department and handed over to the employee by 31st May of the Assessment Year. Also, the tax deduction details appear in Form 26AS which can be accessed by the employee in his Income Tax portal. A copy of Form 16 will be filed in the respective personal file of the employee. For any tax related information and clarification employee can contact Payroll department.

Investment declaration and proof submission Process

13.3.1 Investment declaration by employees

Every year, employees must upload/submit their investment declaration by 15th April in HRMS portal which will be considered to calculate income tax to be deducted from their salary (TDS) on a monthly basis. The declaration format is uploaded in QMS. For further reference w.r.t declaration form visit the below link <http://qms.utthunga.in:8080/process/index/6/23>

13.3.2 Investment proof submission by employees

By December 31, employees must upload/submit their proof of investments made between April to December months of the year in HRMS portal without fail. TDS once made cannot be revised or refunded in any circumstance. Employees must be aware that if the amount of actual investments is less than that which is declared initially, the tax deduction shall automatically be increased to that extent. Wherever the due dates of investments fall after the submission of proofs (i.e., Jan to Mar), employees have to declare the same with the following details:

Sl No	Type of investment (Insurance/ Tax saving Mutual Funds/ PPF, etc.)	Due date of payment	Amount

It is very important to note that the employees must upload/submit the proof of investments made during the period January to March of previous year along with the investment proof submission in HRMS portal.

13.4 Employee Benefits

Employee benefits, also known as perks or fringe benefits, are provided to employees over and above salaries and wages. It is necessary to ensure the commitment and sense of belonging to the organization

of the employees. This is being attained by the organizations through floating some novel schemes for the benefit of the employees, to name just a few:

- **Medical Insurance:** Medical insurance refers to a special kind of health care insurance plan in which individual employees or a group of employees are insured. Sum insured covers self and parents, spouse, and dependent Children (Up to 2).
The Insurance document has been uploaded in HRMS portal.
- **Statutory Bonus:** Bonus is Payable as per the provisions of The Payment of Bonus Act, 1965 for such of the employees whose Basic Salary is less than INR 21,000/-. Currently bonus is being paid to all the employees every month as per the Emoluments package worked out at CTC basis.
- **PF and Gratuity:**
 - **PF:** Provident fund is another name for pension fund. Its purpose is to provide employees with lump sum payments at the time of exit from their place of employment.
Applicable as per the Employees' Provident Funds & Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952.
 - **Gratuity:** Gratuity is a reward for employee loyalty. If an employee stays on in a Company for over 5 years, he is entitled to get gratuity when he retires, resigns, or is retrenched. Is included as a part of your Annual Remuneration denotes the Company's contribution to the Gratuity Fund based on actuarial calculations. Gratuity is payable to you as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, on cessation of your employment after at least 5 years of continuous service with the Company. The amount of gratuity payable shall not exceed Ten Lakh rupees (INR 1,000,000).
Gratuity Calculation = $15/26 \times \text{no of years of Service} \times \text{Current Basic salary}$
- **Rewards and Recognitions:** Managers shall nominate their respective team member for the "Employee of the Quarter" and "Employee of the Year". The nominations shall be finalized by the management with the presence of HR.
- **Lunch:** Company is contributing the free lunch facility to the employees for the working days

14 Policy on Salary Advance

Salary advance refers to employees receiving a portion of their pay before their next scheduled payday.

The detailed information about the policy is uploaded in QMS. Below is the link for the reference:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Salary%20Advance%20policy%20-%20Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf

15 Policy on Employee Relocation

The objective of the relocation policy is to provide financial and administrative relocation assistance. This applies to exempt employees who are required to relocate; because they are being transferred at the Company's request; to a location within the Company.

The detailed information about the policy is uploaded in QMS. Below is the link for the reference:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Employee%20Relocation%20Policy%20-%20Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf

The bonus will be recovered if employee relived before completing 6month from DOJ.

16 Policy on Employee Transfer

Any employee may be asked, at Company's sole discretion to go and work in any department or to any place in India or outside India and the employee may, at any time, be transferred to any of the branch offices, its associates, client's organizations with whom the Company has engagement, and to other office, subsidiary, associate, or organization in existence today or is to be set up hereafter. While every attempt will be made to give the employee reasonable advance notice of such transfer, however, in case of emergency such transfers may be made effective immediately. On employee transfer to any other place, the employee will observe the work timings and holidays as applicable to the location and place of work where the employee has been transferred.

- When transferred to other location within India i.e., from Company's one branch to other branch in different location or Company's office to Client's place in any location within India.
 - a. When transferred within Bangalore or outside Bangalore within India - Allowance will be paid as a beneficiary to the Employee as per the HR Procedures document. Below is the QMS link for reference:
http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Procedure%20document%20-%20Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf
- When transferred outside India i.e., from Company's India office to Client's place outside India
 - a. When travelled outside India on business Visa - Allowance will be paid as a beneficiary to the Employee as per the travel policy document. Below is the QMS link for reference:
http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/TravelPolicy.pdf
 - b. When transferred outside India under work permit – Allowance will be paid as a beneficiary to the Employee as per the travel policy document. Remuneration is depending upon statutory requirement of such country. Below is the QMS link for reference:
http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/TravelPolicy.pdf

17 Policy on Employee Information Privacy

Company, in the course of its business practice and in some cases, as required by Company's policy and law, collects, uses, and maintains personal, sensitive, and identifiable and confidential information about each employee. This information is used only for below mentioned purposes:

- Compliance with central, state, or local laws
- Determination of eligibility for employment, temporary
- Determination of eligibility for employee benefits
- Communication with employees regarding the Company

We respect the privacy of our employees and the confidentiality of personal and sensitive information. At no time will confidential information be knowingly shared or disseminated to unauthorized parties. To attain

this standard, Company has committed significant resources to ensure the safety and confidentiality of our employees' personal information.

As part of our commitment to your privacy, certain policies have been established to protect your information when it is shared inside and outside the Company. Only certain employees are authorized to have access to employee information who have received specific instruction in issues of information confidentiality. It is also necessary for information to be shared with outside organizations such as health plan providers, governmental agencies, and other third-party vendors. In cases where confidential information might be shared, specific written agreements regarding confidentiality are enacted and monitored with any outside organization. In all other cases in which information might be shared with individuals or organizations that may not have specific policies or agreements in place. The employee hereby deemed to have given his/her consent to releasing the information, unless the law prescribes otherwise.

18 Policy on Employee Safety

Employee's safety is the top most priority of this Company. Company provides a clean, hazard free, healthy, and safe environment. The Company is sincerely concerned for the health and well-being of each member of the team. The Company will make every effort to keep the office equipment in excellent condition and make sure that all safety devices are working properly. In order to maintain a secure work environment, the Company strictly prohibits employees and visitors from bringing any firearm and any inflammable materials. Company conducts regular mock fire drill and fire extinguisher sessions to create awareness and quick response practices in the eventuality of fire breakouts and this is mandatory to all employees to comply and be responsive to the safety requirement situations.

The cooperation of every employee is necessary to ensure Company a safe place to work. As an employee, you are expected to take an active part in maintaining this environment. Your workplace should be kept neat, clean, and orderly. Due diligence and personal interest in safety are still the greatest guarantees of your safety at workplace. Begin right by always thinking of safety as you perform your job, or as you learn a new one.

Company expects all employees to bring to the notice of the concerned authority in case of observation of any violation in the safety system and equipment's/arrangements deployed on the work premises. However, any deliberate or ongoing safety violation, or creation of hazard, by an employee will be dealt with disciplinary action by the Company, up to and including termination.

19 Policy on Sexual Harassment

The Company is committed to providing a work environment free of Sexual Harassment and General Harassment. Harassment is a form of discrimination that is offensive, impairs morale, undermines the integrity of employment relationships, and causes serious harm to the productivity, efficiency and stability of our organization. Sexual harassment is a form of workplace harassment of a sexual nature that affects the dignity of women at work.

The Prevention of Sexual Harassment and General Harassment Policy has been formed to prohibit, prevent, or deter the commission of acts of harassment at workplace and to provide the procedure for the redressed of complaints pertaining to Sexual Harassment and General Harassment.

HR shall collect the signed document on POSH and Sexual Harassment awareness policy from the employees on the onboarding day and retain it in the respective employee's file, as per the clause 7.1.4 of ISO 9001:2015.

For further reference w.r.t POSH policy visit the below link:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/POSH%20Policy_Utthunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf

20 Policy on Whistleblower's Protection

Company shall ensure that there is no retaliation against any individual raising a concern of any nature including a privacy related concern. Company also ensures that, to the extent possible, the anonymity of the whistleblower is protected. The whistleblower@utthunga.com email address is available to individuals for reporting their concerns.

21 Policy on Disciplinary Action

All persons who are covered by this Policy must comply with it, and where requested demonstrate such compliance. Failure to comply with this policy can result in disciplinary action which may include termination of services of employees or termination of the engagement of a consultant/contractor or dismissal of interns or volunteers, as the case may be, in accordance with the applicable HR Policy.

22 Policy on Communication

At the Company, courtesy, tact, and consideration should guide each employee in relationships with fellow workers and the public. It is mandatory that each employee in this organization show maximum respect to every other person in the organization and other contacts in a business context. The purpose of communication should be to help others and to make our business run as effectively as possible, thereby gaining the respect of our colleagues and customers.

- Courtesy, friendliness, and a spirit of helpfulness are important and guide the Company's dealings with employees and customers.
- Emails shall be answered within 04 hours, but users must endeavor to answer high priority emails within 02 hours.
- Differences of opinion should be handled privately and discreetly. Gossip and backbiting about the organization are to be avoided if not disciplinary action to be taken by the HR. Communicate directly with the person or persons involved to resolve differences, if not resolved approach HR.
- Conservative and constructive criticism, that which will improve business by clarifying or instructing, should be welcomed when delivered with respect and tact. Destructive criticism, that which is designed to harm business or another person, is not to be practiced.
- Employees should strive to maintain a civil work atmosphere at all times and refrain from shouting, yelling, using vulgarities, or swearing at co-workers or customers or else it may lead to disciplinary action

- The standard of the Company is a work environment free from disparaging remarks about religion, ethnicity, sexual preferences, appearance and other non-work related matters. Each employee has the responsibility to foster an understanding of others' differences in order to create an environment where those differences contribute to a better organization.
- Inappropriate remarks based on any of the following are not tolerated and such behavior will result in immediate termination of employment: race, religion, ethnic origin, physical attributes, mental or physical disability, color, ancestry, marital status, pregnancy, medical condition, citizenship and/or age.
- Inappropriate remarks include those that treat a group of people in a uniform way, assign a behavior in a disparaging way, imply inferiority of a group, are supposedly funny at someone else's expense, and/or cause embarrassment or distress to others based on comments about a particular group of people.

23 Policy on Grievance

Work related problems can arise in any place of employment. We encourage individuals to reconcile differences on an individual basis. Should this not be possible, to resolve a problem quickly and fairly, the Company has developed a grievance procedure using the following steps:

- If employee has a problem, it must be notified to his/her manager immediately. Most difficulties can be settled promptly at this point.
- If the problem is not resolved to employee's satisfaction, he/she may go to the HR department and verbally explain the problem to him/her; or he/she may instead submit the problem in writing by e-mail. If the circumstances require it, the HR department will conduct an investigation and will respond to the grievance. The decision of the HR Department shall be Company's final decision.

24 Policy on Non-Disclosure & Confidentiality

Confidentiality and IP Protection Measures Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) protection risks are tackled with reference to agreements, laws both national and international, data security, physical security, and legal compliance, compliance to security standards, employee contracts and security management training.

The specific practices with respect to confidential information and IPR protection are:

- Every new employee shall sign an agreement not to disclose confidential information or misuse any intellectual property of a third party or of a client
- Company marks its own IP, as also client IP, with appropriate notices
- Access to client IP restricted, both in physical and virtual terms
- Employee computers are password protected – no password sharing permitted

HR shall get Non-Disclosure and Invention Assignment signed by each employee on the onboarding day and retain it in the respective employee's file, as per the clause 7.5 of ISO 90s01:2015. For further reference w.r.t NDA form, visit the below link:

http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Forms/NDA.pdf

25 Company Confidential Information

It is the responsibility of both the immediate manager and HR to emphasize that information on Company products, processes, bids, rates of pay, overhead rates, costs, customers, and other data remain confidential and are not to be released to any person or concern at any time.

Employee responsibilities

- Keep secure all confidential and personal information including business' records of customers. The concerned IT personnel for your business can provide guidance on appropriate computer security practices in this regard
- Do not disclose confidential and personal information even to other employees without proper authorization
- Lock your computers (desktops/laptops) to ensure that information is not accessed by others
- Do not share any of your passwords which you use to access any customer's personal or confidential information with anyone else
- Follow the “clean desk and clear screen” policy. Leave no papers related to the Company or its Client on desk
- If you learn of any suspected, alleged or actual breach of privacy in violation of this policy or your normal business procedures, notify your manager or the legal counsel or the Ombudsperson promptly
- Be particularly careful in dealing with sensitive personal information.
- Follow the “clean board” policy. Mandatorily erase the white board once meeting is concluded

Document categorization and classification process

These procedures require each employee for labeling, storage, transmission, disposal, and maintenance of all records appropriately. This is critical for the Company from regulatory as well as a best policies stand-point. All documents - both soft and hard copies - are labeled as per these procedures. Apart from information intended for public disclosure, all documents or information is classified into one of the following categories: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted.

Compliance with Legal and Regulatory Requirements Pertaining to Data Protection

Company has a strict policy of compliance with data protection laws and regulations, as are relevant in the jurisdiction where it has operations. It ensures that the laws of the data exporting and importing countries are followed in letter as well as in spirit. The Company has implemented various technical and organizational measures to ensure the safety and integrity of confidential data that is received by it for processing.

26 Exit Policy

The purpose of this policy is to have a process in place when an employee is leaving or intends to leave the Company (resignation, retirement, end of contract etc.). When an employee intends to resign, should submit a written letter/email and also initiate the resignation process in HRMS portal of resignation to their immediate manager. During the employee's notice period, must continue to assume their normal responsibilities along with mandatory handover to the existing team, mandatory knowledge transfer (KT) to replacement resource.

On the day of relieving, exit interview shall be conducted with the employee who voluntarily intends to leave the employment of the Company, so as to provide an opportunity for the employees to share information pertaining to their work experience and the factors that contributed to departing. Information from exit interviews may be used to help improve human resource management practices, e.g. recruiting, orientation, performance management, training, working conditions, etc. Additionally, the exit interview provides Company with information that may show trends in voluntary resignations and help Company in improving areas that may be leading to attrition.

26.1 Relieving Formalities

- If any employee intends to resign, it is mandatory for the employee to give a notice in writing to the immediate manager and copy HR via letter /email and also initiate the resignation process in HRMS portal.

and serve the Company during the entire notice period as stipulated in letter of offer/appointment as mutually agreed.

- Employee should clearly specify the reason for resignation.
- Both the manager and the HR must mutually discuss and conclude about the resignation acceptance.
- During notice period employees are not eligible to take any of the leaves except as expressly approved by the manager.
- If an employee avails any of the leaves during the notice period, such leaves will not be set off against the notice period and notice period will get extended to the extent of number of leaves taken.
- In some occasions, if the manager decides to relieve an employee before the end of notice period, it is the responsibility of the manager to update HR Department well in advance (before 30 days) as mentioned in the relieving procedure regarding the prior date of relieving as decided by the manager, so that, HR and Accounts department shall prepare related documents (e.g. exit forms and formalities from HR).
- In the event such information is not received by the HR department, it will be deemed and treated that employee shall serve mandatory full notice as per the letter of offer/appointment. Manager is held accountable for this action.
- All relieving must be recommended by the appropriate manager and approved by the HR Department before the relieving formalities are initiated.
- Once the resignation is accepted and approved, employees are advised to follow the relieving formalities (as mentioned in the Relieving Procedure below).
- Employee under notice period will receive last one-month salary along with full and final settlement only after one month of relieving, subject to the clearance from all respective departments.

- Relieving/experience letter shall be issued only to such employees who have completed/served mandatory full notice period or paid to the Company in lieu of the notice period which shall be at the sole discretion of the management and subject to the NOC (No Objection Certificates) from the respective departments (Finance, IT, Admin and HR) and the activity handover sign-off from the respective Managers.
- Full and final settlement and relieving letter shall be withheld of employees who refuse to serve mandatory notice period, refuse to handover to the existing team and refuse knowledge transfer (KT) to replacement resource.
Company discourages and employee shall not attempt any negotiation of notice period or money in lieu of notice period that is mandatory for all employees to serve 90 days as stipulated in letter of offer/appointment as mutually agreed, which was specified in the appointment letter and duly agreed by the employee at the time of joining. However, case to case basis buyout option can be discussed based on the dependency.

26.1.1 Relieving Procedures

Relieving Procedures to be followed:

- An employee who wishes to resign from employment should mandatorily give a written notice/resignation letter as stipulated in the Letter of Employment and also initiate the resignation process in HRMS portal.
- Manager and HR should do one on one discussion. Once the discussion is done and accepted by Manager and HR, it should be recorded through email.
- One must mandatorily serve the notice period as per the letter of employment, which will be effective from the date of resignation post discussion by the Manager and HR.
- One must complete the project deliverables and dependencies (if any). Also, he/she should follow the procedures w.r.t the knowledge transfer (KT) activities failing which resignation will be treated as termination
- An employee will not be entitled to avail leaves during notice period. Any leaves availed will result in the extension of the notice period
- HR and Manager must identify the resource for the replacement to initiate the knowledge transfer and hand over the activity to the identified resource and it's mandatory for employee resigning to handover and knowledge transfer (KT) to replacement resource or team.
- By considering the relieving date, the HR will conduct the relieving formalities.

The following are the relieving formalities:

- **Activity handover form:** Manager should ensure to get the knowledge transfer (KT) and the handover done from the employee who has resigned to the identified replacement resource or himself before the completion of notice period and confirm it by signing the activity handover form.
- **No due certificate:**
 - Clearance form should be signed by the relevant department heads like IT support, Admin, Finance, Manager, and the HR.

- For deputed employee, clearance to be obtained from the reporting manager at the client location and validated by Utthunga in charge.
- **Exit interview:** An exit interview shall be conducted with the employee which includes the questionnaire about the organization.
- **Relieving and experience letter:** On the date of relieving and upon submission of all the above documents verified by the HR and subject to serving of full notice period, interim relieving and experience letter shall be issued.
- **Full and Final form:** HR will prepare hardcopy of full and final form which the accounts team will verify. The same will be maintained -in HRMS portal

26.2 Company Property, Funds

It is the responsibility of the relieving employee's immediate manager to assure that the employee returns all of Company's property (including, but not limited to drawings, tools, reference data, locker keys, etc.) Prior to the employee's relieving. Access to computer files and email needs to be blocked as well. The manager should check with HR and Accounts department if information on the status of salary, accounts, etc., is required.

26.3 Company Confidential Information

It is the responsibility of both the immediate manager and HR to emphasize that information on Company products, processes, bids, rates of pay, overhead rates, costs, customers, and other data remain confidential and are not to be released to any person or concern at any time.

26.4 Full and Final Settlements:

Relieved employees shall be paid in full for all period worked prior to relieving, provided it is essential that all other department's issues NOC. The payment of full and final settlement is done in the subsequent month from when the employee got relieved i.e., on or before 10th working day

26.5 Retirement

Retirement is an important transition for both the departing employee and the Company on attaining the age of 60 years. Provided however, in exceptional cases an employee may, at the sole direction of the Executive Committee/Board, employee may be retained in service, after attaining the maximum age prescribed on a year-on-year basis if the employee is fit to work and his retention in service is considered to be in the interest of the Company.

27 Policy on Employee Termination

In every case of cessation of employment, it shall be Company's objective to make the separation as amicable as possible for both the employee and the Company. It is best that the relieving employee take with him into the community - a feeling of goodwill towards the Company regardless of departure. Nevertheless, there may be instances where the employee's behavior will cause Company to take action which result in termination of the employee to protect Company's interests. Such a case could include the employee's failure to give proper notice of leaving (normally 90 days), taking Company documents, tools, or other property when he/she leaves. In such cases, the Company may deny due benefits and withholding of relieving

and experience letter. However, in normal circumstances, the separating employee shall be eligible for all due benefits.

It is the responsibility of the terminating employee's immediate manager and respective department to assure that the employee returns all Company property, drawings, tools, reference data, locker keys, etc., prior to the employee's receiving and full and final settlement. Access to computer files needs to be blocked as well. The manager should check with HR and Accounts department if information on the status of salary, accounts, etc., is required.

27.1 Termination

The following are the events that lead to immediate termination by the Company:

- Any declaration given by you or testimonials furnished by you to the Company proves to be false or wrong including background verification/check.
- You are found to have willfully suppressed any material information.
- You are found to have been convicted for or indulged in criminal, subversive or immoral activities.
- You are found to have indulged in financial irregularities.
- You breached any of the terms and conditions of your employment as specified in this letter, or any further official communication from the Company.
- Failure to furnish relieving/experience letter from the previous employer or any other documentary proof to substantiate your transition from the previous employer to the reasonable satisfactory of the Company.
- Unauthorized absence of more than 5 continuous days.
- Guilty of insubordination, lack of commitment, unauthorized absence, disloyalty, misconduct and negligence.
- Any negligence or misconduct on your part.
- Non-performance.
- Fails to follow or comply with Company's policy and guidelines
- Lay off for lack of work - when the Company reduces its work force for economic or other reasons with or without notice.
- Release without fault - when an employee, though no fault of his/her own, is unsuited for or incapable of performing work assigned and no appropriate change of assignment is available.
- Discharge - when an employee who is suited for and capable of performing the work, terminated for such reasons as inefficiency, absenteeism, habitual intermittent or long absenteeism, violation of rules of conduct set forth in the Employee Manual, including, but not limited to, habitual carelessness or recklessness, disorderly conduct, misconduct, negligence, terminated by the client of the Company for non-performance/violation of rules of conduct or otherwise, insubordination, theft, leaving work before relieving and without permission, falsification of records, fails to produce medical records (including fake medical certificates).
- Disability - when, on the basis of medical evidence, an employee is totally and permanently disabled from performing his usual work assignment and thus eligible for disability benefits as per the Company's insurance policy.

- Unauthorized copy, misappropriation, infringement and/or stealing of source code, intellectual property of the Company.
- Any activity that is or leads to conflict with the interest of the Company.
- Breach or violation of any of the below mentioned policies (QMS link for reference) of the Company:

SI N O	Policy Name	QMS link
1	HR policy	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/ProcessDocuments/HR%20Policy%20-%20Version%202.4.pdf
2	NDA/Confidentiality agreement	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Forms/NDA.pdf
3	POSH policy	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/POSH%20Policy_Uttunga%20Technologies%20Pvt%20Ltd.pdf
4	Code of Conduct	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Employee%20Code%20of%20Conduct.pdf
5	Travel Policy	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/TravelPolicy.pdf
6	IT Policies & procedures	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/ProcessDocuments/IT%20Policies%20and%20Procedures.pdf
7	Social media policy	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Social%20Media%20Policy-Aug-2020.pdf
8	IP confidentiality document	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/ProcessDocuments/IT%20Policies%20and%20Procedures.pdf (Refer section 23)
9	Quality manual	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/Guidelines/Quality_Manual%20.pdf
10	Infrastructure maintenance	http://192.168.2.254:8080/CMS/QMS_Uploads/ProcessLibrary/ProcessDocuments/InfrastructureMaintenance.pdf

Full and final settlement and relieving letter shall be withheld of employees who are terminated for any of the foregoing reasons.

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